



AP



PRESIDENT OBAMA HAS A UNIQUE
EMPATHY WITH THE MASSES
THAT FEW LEADERS CAN MATCH

tures between companies belonging to the two countries to promote technology in diverse areas such as agriculture, food security and public health. Somers predicts, "President Obama will be a game changer in that his vitality and far thinking vision will appeal universally to India's dynamism, to its entrepreneurial 'can-do DNA' and to its youthful demography."

HOW SHOULD INDIA DEAL WITH HIM?

Conducting international relations in the Obama era would be like playing a game of speed chess. The pieces will never be frozen for long and will be constantly on the move. Linear, cubicle thinking is out and so too is shrillness and finger wagging. Nor should India, work itself into a Greek tragedy where the chorus lays out the plot

FOR INDIA, TIES WITH THE US IN THE OBAMA ERA WILL BE A GAME OF SPEED CHESS. LINEAR AND CUBICAL THINKING IS OUT; SMART DIPLOMACY IS IN.

and the actors play their roles.

Dealing with Obama calls for 'smart' diplomacy on India's part too. Instead of looking at the relationship through the prism of the past, India should seek out the new America. Stephen Cohen of the Brookings Institution, says: "This America is more open, more flexible and more true to itself than at any other time in my memory." There is a rare convergence of interests between the US and India, whether it's on energy, terrorism or the environ-

ment. Like most Indians, Obama emerged from the patchwork quilt that is America today not having a life of privilege. There was no bubble that shielded him from the realities of the world and as he went on to attain greatness he did not lose sight of his humble beginnings. India must welcome his ascendancy and work towards harnessing the electric energy that he exudes.

For more stories, pictures and videos,
Click to www.indiatoday.in/obama

